

WORLD OBESITY DAY: TREATMENT THAT FOCUSES ON HEALTH; NOT JUST THE WEIGHING SCALE

World Obesity Day draws attention to one of the most pressing health concerns of our time. Obesity is not simply about body weight. It is associated with conditions such as diabetes, high blood pressure, heart disease, joint disorders and fatty liver. Across age groups and regions, its impact is increasingly visible. On this occasion, experts share their experience of managing obesity as a chronic medical condition and why timely, structured care matters.



DR. VENU GOPAL PAREEK, Senior Laparoscopic and Bariatric Surgeon, Amicus Speciality Clinic, Hyderabad

Over the years, I observed obesity becoming more common across different age groups and backgrounds. It was no longer limited to a particular lifestyle or profession. Many individuals were managing excess weight along with diabetes or hypertension. Repeated attempts at dieting often led to temporary weight loss followed by regain, which created discouragement. Lifestyle modification always remained the foundation of treatment. I consistently advised balanced nutrition, regular physical activity and behavioural changes under professional guidance. In cases of severe obesity where these measures did not provide sustained benefit, bariatric surgery was considered after careful medical evaluation. The objective was not cosmetic change, but improvement in overall metabolic health. World Obesity Day reminds us that obesity is a chronic condition requiring structured medical support rather than self-directed, short-term efforts.

DR. VENU MADHAV , Senior Consultant - Laparoscopic and Bariatric Surgeon, Blue Hospital, Hyderabad

In my experience, obesity affected much more than physical appearance. Individuals frequently reported reduced stamina, poor sleep quality and difficulty maintaining daily routines. Over time, excess weight influenced blood sugar control and blood pressure stability. For appropriately selected patients, bariatric surgery formed part of a comprehensive treatment pathway. Under medical supervision, some individuals experienced improved glycaemic control and were able to review their medication requirements. However, surgery was always combined with dietary discipline, activity modification and long-term follow-up. The emphasis remained on sustainable health improvement rather than rapid weight reduction. World Obesity Day encourages a shift in thinking — from viewing obesity as a lifestyle issue to recognising it as a medical condition that benefits from evidence-based care. World Obesity Day is an opportunity to move beyond stigma and towards responsible action. Recognising obesity as a medical condition encourages timely consultation and evidence-based care. With appropriate evaluation and sustained commitment, individuals can work towards improved health and better quality of life.



DISCLAIMER: The view/suggestions/opinions expressed in the article are the sole responsibility of the brand concerned this should not be considered a substitute for medical advise. Please consult your treating physician for more details.